MODULE 40 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL SECTIONS

What Changed: Names, Retirements, Guide vs Today

Every 2026 rename with its date, what kept its old name underneath, the products that were retired, and how to answer when the exam and the console disagree.

SECTIONS All five MODULE 40 of 45 SCENARIOS 4

admin@sthithapragna.com

The guide was written before the renames. **Know both names, and answer with the one the question uses.**

admin@sthithapragna.com

What the official pages say, on 10 October 2026

- Banner: the exam "will soon be updated to reflect recent branding changes".
- The guide still says **Dataproc**, **Cloud Composer**, **BigLake**, **Dataplex**, **Analytics Hub**, **Cloud DLP**.
- Weights unchanged: **22, 25, 20, 15 and 18** percent across the five sections.
- 2 hours, **40 to 50** questions. The pass mark is not published.

> CURRENCY CHECK
>
> Expect old names on the exam. Expect new names in the console and the docs.

The April 2026 renames

THE EXAM GUIDE SAYS	NOW CALLED	SINCE
Dataplex	Knowledge Catalog	10 Apr 2026
Looker Studio	Data Studio, again	16 Apr 2026
Dataproc	Managed Service for Apache Spark	22 Apr 2026
BigLake	Google Cloud Lakehouse	22 Apr 2026
Vertex AI	Gemini Enterprise Agent Platform	22 Apr 2026
Cloud Composer	Managed Service for Apache Airflow	April 2026

REMEMBER

Six names in two weeks. The products, prices and behaviour did not change.

Older and smaller renames

OLDER NAME	NOW CALLED
Analytics Hub	BigQuery sharing. The guide uses both.
Cloud DLP	Sensitive Data Protection
Cloud Functions	Cloud Run functions, since August 2024
BigLake metastore	Lakehouse runtime catalog
Anywhere Cache	Rapid Cache, for Cloud Storage
Cloud Skills Boost	Google Skills, used for renewals

THE PATTERN

If an option names either version of a pair, treat them as the same product.

What kept the old name underneath

- **CLIs**: still gcloud dataproc, gcloud composer, gcloud dataplex.
- **APIs, client libraries and IAM roles**: unchanged, such as roles/dataproc.editor.
- **SQL values**: a registered model still says MODEL_REGISTRY = 'VERTEX_AI'.
- An option using an old command name is **not** outdated, and not wrong.

> THE TIEBREAKER
>
> The rename is a label on the box. Everything inside the box kept its name.

What was retired, and what replaced it

RETIRED	WHEN	USE INSTEAD
Pub/Sub Lite	Turned down 18 Mar 2026	Pub/Sub, or Managed Kafka
Data Catalog	Shut down from 1 Jun 2026	Knowledge Catalog
Managed Airflow Gen 1	End of life 15 Sep 2026	Gen 3, or Gen 2
gsutil	Leaves the gcloud CLI after Mar 2027	gcloud storage
CSEK for Compute Engine	Deprecated	CMEK in Cloud KMS

THE TRAP

A renamed product can still be the answer. A retired one never is, for a new design.

SQL that moved to a new prefix

- Current docs teach **AI.GENERATE_TEXT**, **AI.GENERATE_EMBEDDING** and **AI.EMBED**.
- Older material says **ML.GENERATE_TEXT** and **ML.GENERATE_EMBEDDING**.
- **VECTOR_SEARCH**, CREATE VECTOR INDEX and ML.FORECAST keep their names.
- TimesFM forecasting, with **AI.FORECAST**, needs no training at all.

> REMEMBER
>
> Either prefix on the exam means the same idea: a remote model called from SQL.

Recent additions worth recognising

- BigQuery **managed disaster recovery** and **continuous queries**.
- **Autonomous embeddings**: a column that embeds itself, with AI.EMBED.
- **Managed Service for Apache Kafka**, and Pub/Sub **single message transforms**.
- June 2026: Dataflow adds **automated stop-and-replace** streaming updates.

> THE SIGNAL
>
> The guide predates these. If one appears, it is usually the newest, simplest answer.

admin@sthithapragna.com

GA or Preview?

GENERALLY AVAILABLE

Safe exam answers

- Covered by the SLA
- Supported for production
- What exam answers assume
- Most of this course

PREVIEW

Know them, rarely pick them

- No SLA, may change
- Bigtable subscriptions from Pub/Sub
- AI.SEARCH, Lakehouse caching
- Data governance tags

THE TIEBREAKER

When an option only works through a Preview feature, prefer the GA route if one exists.

Phrases that pick the answer

THE QUESTION SAYS	TREAT IT AS
Dataproc, or a Dataproc cluster	Managed Service for Apache Spark
Cloud Composer, a Composer environment	Managed Airflow
Dataplex, lakes, zones, aspects	Knowledge Catalog
BigLake tables, Iceberg	Lakehouse
Pub/Sub Lite for a new system	Retired. Choose another option.
Data Catalog tag templates	Retired. Knowledge Catalog aspects.

THE PATTERN

Translate the name, then answer the question as if nothing changed.

> Larkspur's governance team wants every BigQuery table and lake bucket searchable in one place, with business owner and sensitivity recorded on each.
>
> The design must still be supported in 2027.

Which service should hold this metadata?

A Data Catalog, with a tag template for owner and sensitivity

B Knowledge Catalog, with an aspect type for owner and sensitivity

C Sensitive Data Protection, storing results in its inspection jobs

D BigQuery sharing, publishing every dataset as a private listing

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which service should hold this metadata?

A Data Catalog

Shut down from June 2026.

B Knowledge Catalog

Formerly Dataplex. Aspects carry the fields.

C Sensitive Data Protection

Finds sensitive data. It is not a catalogue.

D BigQuery sharing

Shares data. It does not catalogue it.

THE SIGNAL

Catalogue and tag, still supported: Knowledge Catalog, formerly Dataplex.

> An acquired business streams usage events from on-premises Kafka producers. The team wants a Google-managed service with the fewest code changes.
>
> An old design document proposes Pub/Sub Lite to keep costs down.

What should the team use?

A. Pub/Sub Lite zonal topics, as the old design document proposes

B. Pub/Sub standard topics, after rewriting every producer's client

C. Managed Service for Apache Kafka, keeping the Kafka producers

D. Self-managed Kafka brokers on Compute Engine virtual machines

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team use?

A Pub/Sub Lite

Turned down in March 2026.

B Pub/Sub

Works, but every producer must be rewritten.

C Managed Kafka

Kafka clients unchanged, Google runs the brokers.

D Self-managed Kafka

Not Google-managed. The team runs the brokers.

THE SIGNAL

Kafka clients, managed, fewest changes: Managed Service for Apache Kafka.

> The settlement DAGs still run in an old Managed Airflow environment, created years ago as Composer 1, now listed as Legacy Gen 1.
>
> It is October 2026. The team asks what to do with it.

What should the team do?

A Leave it alone, because Legacy Gen 1 is supported until 2028

B Rewrite every DAG as a Workflows definition in YAML instead

C Move the DAGs into Cloud Run jobs triggered by Cloud Scheduler

D Migrate the DAGs to a new Managed Airflow Gen 3 environment

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team do?

A Leave it

Gen 1 reached end of life in September 2026.

B Workflows

A full rewrite, and a poor fit for data DAGs.

C Cloud Run jobs

Loses retries, backfills and dependencies.

D Migrate to Gen 3

Same Airflow DAGs, a supported platform.

THE SIGNAL

Past end of life: migrate within the same product, to Gen 3.

> A nightly script copies settlement files with gsutil. The team now wants soft delete and managed folders on the bucket.
>
> The script must keep working after the next Google Cloud CLI upgrades.

What should the team change?

A Rewrite the script with gcloud storage commands

B Keep gsutil, and pin an old version of the CLI package

C Replace the script with a Storage Transfer Service job

D Replace the copy with bq load into a BigQuery staging table

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team change?

A gcloud storage

Current, supports the new features, stays in the CLI.

B Pin old gsutil

Minimally maintained, and lacks those features.

C Storage Transfer

Possible, but more than the task needs.

D bq load

Loads tables. It does not copy files.

THE SIGNAL

A legacy tool leaving the CLI: move to its named successor.

Module 40 in five lines

- The exam uses **old names**. The console uses new ones. Learn both.
- April 2026: **Dataproc, Composer, BigLake, Dataplex, Vertex AI, Looker Studio** renamed.
- CLIs, APIs, IAM roles and SQL values kept the **old names**.
- **Retired**: Pub/Sub Lite, Data Catalog, Airflow Gen 1. Never pick them for new work.
- Prefer **GA** over Preview. Translate the name, then answer.

> COMING UP
>
> Next: module 41, confusion pairs, side by side.